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A DESIGN-BASED RESEARCH PROJECT: MOES TUINEN

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CLASS: 4TH YEAR - 1A

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Executive Summary

This report outlines a collaborative, real-world design process with **MOES Tuinen**—an urban gardening initiative in Amstelveen—to address challenges in brand awareness and audience engagement, [REDACTED]. Developed within the framework of the Design-Based Research (DBR) Graduation Module, the project aimed to address key challenges in brand awareness and customer engagement—[REDACTED]—while also exploring scalable concepts to support MOES’s future development.

Through stakeholder input, desk and field research—including bilingual surveys, interviews, trend analysis, and more—the core challenge was identified and translated into a clear design question. Four design frames were developed to explore possible solutions, including ideas related to **brand awareness**, **on-site communication**, **community education**, and a future **staffless store**. These concepts were tested through stakeholder validation and iterative feedback.

The final implementation focused on a **pop-up stand activation at PureMarkt**, where **branded grow kits** and **flyers** were distributed to engage the community and promote MOES’s mission. Supporting deliverables included the creation of an **intro ad** of MOES Tuinen, **short interview-based video series (“Meet the Gardeners”)** and a **voice-over recap video for social media**. These assets served both as research validation tools and as content to increase MOES’s digital visibility.

The report outlines the full DBR process—research, ideation, testing, and real-world execution—culminating in a targeted social media strategy to support MOES’s long-term marketing efforts.

This project shows how **tailored communication strategies**, based on **user insights** and **iterative testing**, can support socially-driven organizations like MOES Tuinen in expanding their **visibility** and local presence.



1. Introduction



Urban gardening has emerged as a vital response to the challenges of urbanization, offering sustainable solutions for food production, community engagement, and environmental stewardship (Pradhan et al., 2024). In the Netherlands, this movement has gained momentum, with initiatives like MOES in Amstelveen leading the way in promoting accessible and community-driven gardening experiences (MOES Tuinen Amstelveen, 2025). This report explores the collaborative project undertaken with MOES, focusing on enhancing its brand visibility and community outreach through design-based research methodologies.

1.1 Project Background & Context

MOES is a family-run urban gardening initiative based in Amstelveen, Netherlands. Founded by the Kolk family, MOES provides individuals with access to year-round personal vegetable plots in a professional greenhouse setting. The initiative promotes sustainable living, offering tools, organic materials, and expert guidance to help users grow their own food while fostering community and environmental awareness (MOES Tuinen Amstelveen, 2025).

In addition to garden plots, MOES regularly organizes workshops and community events, emphasizing education and ecological engagement. This inclusive, hands-on approach appeals to both local residents and the city's large expat population, who seek accessible, health-conscious, and socially enriching experiences (MOES Tuinen Amstelveen, 2025).



The organization has also seen a rise in public recognition following coverage in multiple local news outlets. Articles in **AmstelveenZ**, **Amstelveens Nieuwsblad**, and **Mijn Amstelveen** have praised MOES for its community impact, sustainable renovation efforts, and successful collaboration with local government in securing permits for expansion (AmstelveenZ, 2024; Amstelveens Nieuwsblad, 2024; Mijn Amstelveen, 2024). This media visibility has contributed to MOES's increasing popularity and demand, further reinforcing its role as a leading force in urban gardening within the region.

1.2 Client Description



MOES Tuinen is a family-operated urban gardening initiative located in Amstelveen, Netherlands. Founded by the **Kolk family**, MOES provides individuals with the opportunity to engage in year-round gardening within a greenhouse setting. Participants are allocated **personal vegetable garden plots**, complete with necessary tools and resources, fostering a hands-on approach to sustainable living and community building (MOES Tuinen Amstelveen, 2025).

Beyond providing gardening spaces, MOES emphasizes **education** and **community involvement**. The initiative conducts **workshops** and events aimed at teaching sustainable gardening practices, thereby cultivating a community of environmentally conscious individuals (MOES Tuinen Amstelveen, 2025).

MOES has gained significant popularity following coverage in local media outlets, which highlighted its sustainable renovation efforts and contribution to addressing the shortage of urban gardening spaces in the region (AmstelveenZ, 2024; Amstelveens Nieuwsblad, 2024; Mijn Amstelveen, 2024).



Industry: Urban Agriculture in the Netherlands

Urban agriculture in the Netherlands is a growing movement that integrates food production into urban settings, addressing sustainability, community engagement, and food security. The country has seen a rise in initiatives that transform urban spaces into productive agricultural areas, contributing to environmental and social objectives (Urban Green-Blue Grids, 2025).

In cities like **Amsterdam** and **Rotterdam**, urban agriculture projects have been implemented to utilize available spaces for food production, often supported by municipal policies that encourage green initiatives. These projects not only provide fresh produce but also serve as educational platforms and community hubs, promoting social cohesion and environmental awareness (Agritecture, 2023).

The Dutch approach to urban agriculture often involves innovative practices, such as vertical farming and the use of technology to optimize growing conditions. This integration of modern techniques with traditional farming practices exemplifies the country's commitment to sustainable urban development (Agroberichten Buitenland, 2022).

Competitors & Similar Initiatives

While MOES operates within a unique niche, several other initiatives in the Netherlands offer similar services:



1.3 Problem Statement



These four interconnected challenges—brand awareness, on-site communication, staffless retail, and community engagement—formed the foundation of this design-based research project. They were explored through four distinct design frames, each grounded in research and stakeholder input, and iteratively tested to develop viable, value-driven solutions.

1.4 Research Questions & Methodology

This project was structured around four interconnected challenges identified through stakeholder input and contextual analysis: limited brand awareness, inefficient on-site communication, the potential development of a staffless store, and the desire to foster education and community connection. These challenges informed the Design-Based Research (DBR) approach, where iterative research and design were used to explore and prototype possible solutions.

The following research questions were formulated to guide the exploration and development of design solutions:

Design-Based Research Questions

These questions emerged from a combination of primary research insights, stakeholder discussions, and theoretical exploration. By addressing brand visibility, communication design, spatial innovation, and educational engagement, the project aimed to deliver tangible, context-specific interventions. The iterative nature of the DBR approach allowed for continuous refinement of both the problem definition and proposed solutions, aligning them closely with user needs, expert input, and practical feasibility.

The following research questions were formulated to guide the exploration and development of design interventions:

Main Design-Based Research Question

How might we develop communication strategies and spatial interventions that improve MOES Tuinen's brand awareness, customer experience, and community engagement among a diverse and growing audience in Amstelveen?

Sub-Design-Based Research Questions

- *How might we help MOES Tuinen reach a broader audience—especially expats—and raise awareness about its offerings in an engaging way?*
- *How might we improve MOES Tuinen's on-site communication so that customers receive clear, timely, and accessible updates and instructions?*
- *How might we design a functional, intuitive, and secure staffless self-service store experience that meets the needs of MOES Tuinen's visitors?*
- *How might we create more opportunities for knowledge sharing, connection, and a stronger sense of community among MOES Tuinen gardeners?*

These questions served as the foundation for the research and prototyping process, shaping the development and refinement of four design frames, each supported by stakeholder feedback and iterative testing.

Methodology

This project followed the Design-Based Research (DBR) methodology, which involves iterative cycles of research, ideation, prototyping, testing, and reflection. DBR is especially suitable for practice-based creative problem solving in real-world settings—making it an ideal framework for tackling the layered challenges MOES Tuinen faces as it expands.

The process was structured across four core phases:

**1. Problem
Analysis &
Exploration**

**2. Data
Collection &
User Research**

**3. Ideation &
Design
Framing**

**4. Prototyping,
Testing &
Iteration**

1. Problem Analysis & Exploration

Initial desk research was conducted on urban agriculture trends, sustainability practices, and brand engagement within multicultural communities. These insights were enriched through field visits, stakeholder meetings, and informal conversations with MOES Tuinen's founder. Four key challenge areas were identified:

2. Data Collection & User Research

To validate and deepen the initial findings, a bilingual (Dutch-English) survey was distributed digitally to current MOES Tuinen members after selecting the final design direction.

MOES Tuinen's Open Day, offering qualitative input on user behavior, motivations, and emotional connections to the garden.

AI tools supported the process by paraphrasing some content, refining Dutch-English translations for i.e. surveys, and visualizing research models from text see **Appendix M p. 125** for more info.

3. Ideation & Design Framing

To translate research into actionable ideas, various creative techniques were employed:

- Mind Mapping to visualize relationships between user needs and service gaps.
- Observation / Shadowing to better understand how users interact with MOES Tuinen's space.
- "How might we" questions to turn insights into design challenges.
- Value Proposition Canvas to align MOES's offerings with user expectations.
- Brainstorming & synthesis sessions to generate four initial design frames.

These four frames were presented to Wouter Kolk, who helped narrow them down to two. One was ultimately selected for execution based on feasibility, impact, and alignment with the organization's values.

4. Prototyping, Testing & Iteration

The selected concept was developed into low-fidelity prototypes, including stand sketches, grow kit packaging, and flyer drafts. A separate survey was created to test these prototypes and gather user feedback. Real-world testing occurred during the PureMarkt activation, where visitors interacted with the pop-up stand and received grow kits with instructions. A short-form video campaign with interviews and event highlights was shared via MOES Tuinen's social media platforms to evaluate digital engagement. All interventions were assessed for feasibility, user appeal, and consistency with MOES Tuinen's mission and values.

1.5 Core Tasks Overview

This graduation project demonstrates proficiency in two core tasks of the Creative Business programme, as defined by the International Creative Business (ICB) curriculum. These core tasks are integrated throughout the design-based research process and are reflected in both the approach and the deliverables of the project.

Core Task: Research

This task focuses on identifying complex problems, conducting structured research, and translating insights into practical solutions.

Within this project, research was used to uncover barriers related to brand awareness, on-site communication, staffless retail, and community engagement at MOES Tuinen.

The iterative nature of this research is evident in the multiple testing cycles:

Initial survey findings informed the design frames, which were then validated and refined through targeted surveys and feedback loops with both users and the main stakeholder (Wouter Kolk, personal communication, 2025).

Core Task : Marketing (Chosen)

The second core task demonstrated is Core Task 3: Marketing, which focuses on designing and delivering strategic communication and media content that supports the positioning and promotion of products or services. This task was expressed through the development of a communication strategy to increase MOES Tuinen's visibility and reach—particularly among expats and international residents. Marketing outputs included social media content: "Meet the gardener" mini series, a branded pop-up stand activation at Pure Markt at Amstedamse Bos on the 18th of May 2025, flyers, creation of grow kits to be given as giveaways, and an end social media video featuring event coverage with a voiceover as a recap to the whole project. These deliverables were developed, tested, and refined in real-world conditions, contributing directly to the client's visibility and community outreach goals.

A close-up photograph of a hand holding a green garden hose nozzle. The nozzle is spraying a fine mist of water onto green foliage. The background is dark and out of focus.

2. Research & Problem Definition

This chapter presents the research phase that laid the foundation for defining MOES Tuinen's core challenges and shaping the design process. The aim was to gain a deep understanding of the context in which MOES operates, including market trends, user behaviors, stakeholder needs, and more. The research approach combined desk research, field research, and user testing, resulting in clear insights that informed the development of four strategic design frames. This chapter begins with desk research to explore relevant industry trends and benchmark MOES Tuinen within the broader context of urban agriculture and community engagement.

2.1 Desk Research

To support and validate the initial problem definition, desk research was conducted to contextualize MOES Tuinen's strategic position within the urban gardening and sustainability landscape. This analysis included a multi-level trend assessment using the Trend Pyramid model, an industry benchmarking scan to evaluate competitors, a SWOT analysis to map internal strengths and weaknesses against external factors, and Porter's Value Chain to identify where and how value is currently created—and where potential gaps lie. Together, these tools provide a comprehensive overview of MOES Tuinen's environment and operational challenges, forming the foundation for the design decisions made in the next stages of this project. Here are the justifications why each model was used:

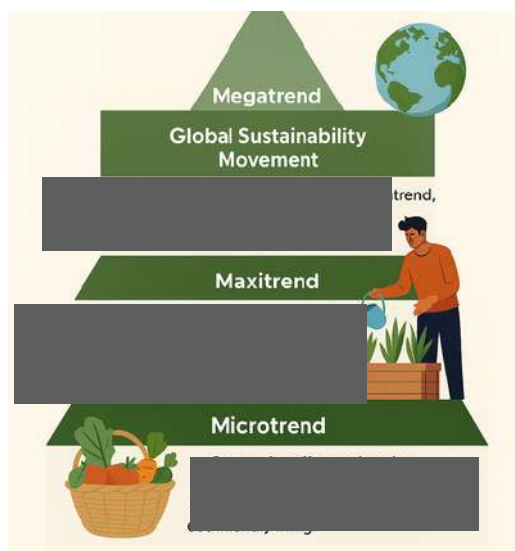
- **Trend Pyramid** was used to identify and categorize relevant macro, meso, and micro trends. It provided a structured understanding of how global sustainability movements, national urban agriculture policies, and local community gardening behaviors converge—making it essential for long-term strategic alignment (Van Os, 2024).
- **Industry Insights & Competitor Benchmarking** allowed for contextual positioning within the Dutch urban gardening space. This comparison highlighted MOES Tuinen's unique value proposition
- **SWOT Analysis** was applied to synthesize internal strengths and weaknesses alongside external opportunities and threats.

This model served as a strategic snapshot that clarified areas requiring innovation and improvement, directly informing the design frames (Kenton, 2025).

- **Porter's Value Chain** was selected to map how value is currently created across MOES Tuinen's activities. It revealed operational strengths such

Together, these models enabled a holistic understanding of MOES Tuinen's position and challenges, ensuring that the solutions developed were both relevant and actionable.

Trend Pyramid: Sustainability in Urban Gardening



p.73

Figure 1

Trend Pyramid:
Sustainability in
Urban Gardening

(See **Appendix A**
for full-size visual)

The Trend Pyramid (Lindgren & Bandhold, 2009) categorizes societal shifts across three levels—megatrends, maxitrends, and microtrends. This model was used to assess MOES Tuinen's alignment with broader environmental and consumer trends:

- **Megatrend – Global Sustainability Movement**



- **Microtrend – Community Gardens & Self-Sufficient Spaces**



This trend structure demonstrates that MOES Tuinen is well-positioned within both long-term environmental movements and short-term lifestyle trends.



Industry Insights & Competitor Benchmarking

p.74

Industry Insights & Competitor Benchmarking



Figure 2

Industry Insights &
Competitor
Benchmarking

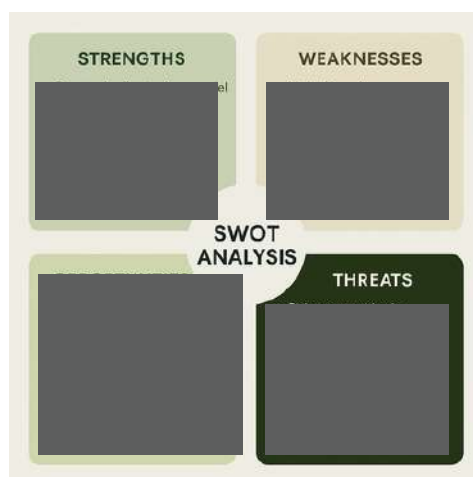
(See **Appendix A**
for full-size visual)

To further contextualize MOES's position, a brief competitor scan was conducted across the Dutch urban gardening and sustainability space:





SWOT Analysis: Internal & External Scan



p.74

Figure 3

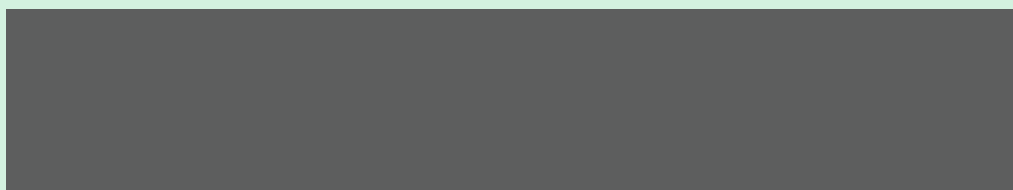
SWOT Analysis:
Internal & External
Scan

(See **Appendix A**
for full-size visual)

Based on the desk research findings and initial stakeholder discussions, a SWOT analysis was developed to summarize MOES Tuinen's current strategic position. This framework combines internal strengths and weaknesses with external opportunities and threats (MOES Tuinen, personal communication, 2025).

Strengths

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Weaknesses

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Opportunities

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Threats

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-

Porter's Value Chain Analysis: Value Creation at MOES Tuinen



p.75

Figure 4

Porter's Value
Chain Analysis

(See **Appendix A**
for full-size visual
and description)

To complement the trend and SWOT analyses, Porter's Value Chain model (Eelants, 2024) was used to examine MOES Tuinen's internal activities and identify how value is created, delivered, and where improvements could be made. The model divides business activities into primary and support activities. Each of these areas was assessed in relation to MOES's operations, customer experience, and communication strategies.

2.2 Field Research

To complement the desk research and deepen understanding of the real-world challenges faced by MOES Tuinen, a mixed-methods field research approach was conducted between February and May 2025. The goal was to collect actionable insights directly from both the client and the MOES community through stakeholder feedback, surveys, interviews, and observational studies.

This phase of research was crucial in shaping the design frames and informing the final concept direction. Each method offered a different lens through which to understand user behavior, communication needs, emotional motivations, and operational realities. The combination of structured and exploratory tools ensured the research was both rigorous and grounded in the lived experiences of MOES Tuinen members.

Stakeholder Feedback Meetings

Between February and May 2025, several feedback meetings were conducted with Wouter Kolk, the founder of MOES Tuinen. These sessions served as key evaluation moments throughout the project, during which concept drafts, design frames, and communication materials were presented for validation, critique, and refinement. Furthermore, I attended the DBR (circle) meetings online, where I also received feedback from ICB teachers. Documentation of these meetings—including slide decks – **is available in the appendix (B) p.76.**

Key Insights from Stakeholder Feedback (Wouter Kolk, personal communication, 2025):

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-
-
-

The feedback gathered during these meetings significantly influenced the direction of each design frame, ensuring alignment with MOES Tuinen's operational context, goals, and values.

Survey Method & Insights

A Google Forms bilingual survey (Dutch and English) was developed in collaboration with the client, Wouter Kolk, and distributed to MOES Tuinen members in April 2025 (**See Appendix C p.77-81 for questions and results**).

The aim was to

The questions were carefully co-developed with Wouter to reflect MOES Tuinen's specific communication and operational challenges, ensuring alignment with both business priorities and the project's design goals.

Survey Objectives

The survey was designed to:

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These objectives directly informed the four design frames explored in the project and supported an evidence-based iteration process.

Survey Design and Topics

The survey included 13 questions, both multiple-choice and open-ended, covering:

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Key Insights

- **Brand Discovery:**

- **Reasons for Joining:**

- **Satisfaction:**

- **Social Media Platforms:**

- **Communication Preferences:**

- **Event Participation:**

- **Areas for Improvement:**

These insights played a critical role in shaping the final design solutions and provided strong evidence to support the problem framing established earlier in the project.

Interviews with MOES Members

To gain qualitative insights from the community, several on-site interviews were conducted during MOES Tuinen's Open Day on the 6th of April 2025. These conversations served both research and communication purposes—providing input for user-centered design, and simultaneously being used to create an authentic social media video showcasing real member stories.

All interviewees were current MOES Tuinen members, and their perspectives captured the emotional, practical, and social value of participating in urban gardening. **Full transcripts are provided in the appendix (D p.82).**

Key Themes Identified



These findings reinforced the four design challenges identified in this project.

On-Site Observations

To complement survey results and interview insights, several on-site visits were conducted at MOES Tuinen's greenhouse and garden plots between February and May 2025. These sessions focused on observing customer behavior, site interaction patterns, and communication dynamics. Observational research was guided by a human-centered lens to identify pain points and opportunities within the existing experience.

Key Observations



2.3 Target Audience Analysis

Understanding the target audience was essential to defining MOES Tuinen's communication strategy and designing meaningful interventions. The analysis draws from survey data, client interviews, on-site observations, and regional demographic reports (Gemeente Amstelveen, 2024). It focuses on current and potential users—particularly expatriates, professionals, and urban residents seeking sustainable, community-based experiences.

Demographics



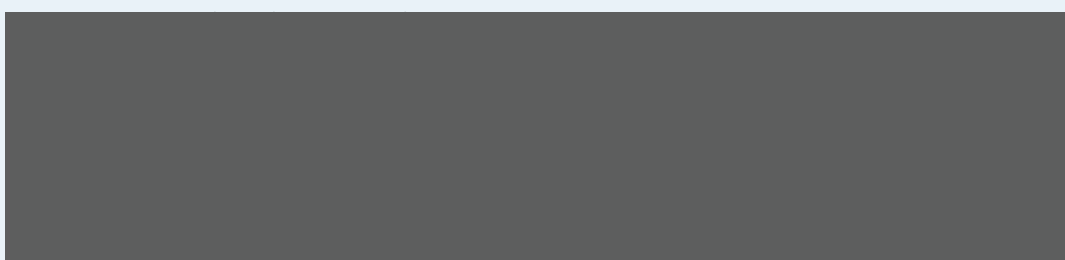
Geographics



Psychographics



Behavioral Attributes



Primary Segments



This audience profile informed the tone, format, and delivery methods of the communication materials, ensuring alignment with both MOES Tuinen's mission and the expectations of its community.

User Persona



User Persona: Lila Mehta

Age: 34

Nationality: Indian

Occupation: UX Designer at a tech company in Amsterdam

Residence: Amstelveen (moved 2 years ago)

Languages: English (fluent), Hindi, basic Dutch

Household: Lives with partner, no children

Goals & Motivations

- Find a way to grow her own vegetables and herbs sustainably
- Reconnect with nature and reduce screen fatigue
- Discover meaningful community experiences in Amstelveen
- Engage in hobbies that align with wellness and eco-conscious values

Challenges

- Unaware of MOES Tuinen's existence despite living nearby
- Feels disconnected from hyper-local services due to language/cultural barriers
- Often scrolls past Dutch-only Instagram ads or local event flyers
- Finds it difficult to identify authentic community projects amidst commercial noise

Preferred Communication Channels

- Instagram Reels and visual storytelling
- WhatsApp groups for local tips and updates
- Occasionally checks Facebook events
- Listens to podcasts or short-form YouTube content during commute

Values

- Sustainable living and ethical consumption
- Inclusive communities and cultural exchange
- Health, mental well-being, and work-life balance
- Authentic experiences over commercial ones

Quote

"I'd love to join something that feels local, relaxing, and green—but I rarely hear about these things unless a friend shares it. I follow community pages, but it's hard to tell what's worth checking out."

Empathy Map



p.83

Figure 5

Empathy Map

(See **Appendix E** for full-size visual)

This empathy map visualizes the thoughts, feelings, behaviors, and needs of a typical MOES Tuinen user—based on interviews, survey data, and field observations. The map synthesizes what users say, do, think, and feel, offering a human-centered understanding of their motivations and pain points. It reveals the emotional connection users have to gardening, their desire for community and sustainability, and challenges with communication and accessibility. These insights directly informed the tone, content, and structure of the project's design interventions.

2.4 Research Quality: Reliability, Validity & Limitations

This research project was conducted using the Design-Based Research (DBR) methodology, which is well-suited for practice-based creative problem-solving in real-world contexts. DBR allows for iterative cycles of exploration, ideation, prototyping, testing, and reflection—making it particularly effective for stakeholder-driven innovation in applied (Lewis et al., 2020). Each phase was supported by a combination of qualitative and quantitative methods, including surveys, stakeholder meetings, interviews, and observations.

Reliability

Reliability refers to the consistency and dependability of research results (Bryman, 2016). Several measures were implemented to ensure data integrity:

- The bilingual survey was co-developed with the client to ensure content relevance and reduce misinterpretation. It was distributed in both Dutch and English to enhance accessibility for MOES Tuinen's multilingual audience.
- Standardized question formats were used to collect consistent data across respondents, increasing the comparability of answers.
- Survey findings were triangulated with qualitative insights from interviews and stakeholder conversations to identify repeated patterns and reduce bias (Dye, 2025).
- Multiple on-site visits were conducted across the semester, ensuring that observations reflected recurring behaviors rather than isolated incidents.

Validity

Validity assesses whether the research methods accurately captured what they intended to measure (Middleton, 2023). The following steps enhanced the study's internal and construct validity:

- All research instruments (e.g., survey, interview prompts) were designed in alignment with clearly defined project goals and were reviewed by the client for content validity (Wouter Kolk, personal communication, 2025).
- The sample was aligned with MOES Tuinen's actual user base, which includes expats, professionals, and community-minded residents, ensuring representative input.

- Triangulation was applied using three research methods—surveys, interviews, and observations—to corroborate findings across data sources and reduce single-source bias (Bhandari, 2023).
- Feedback loops with the client throughout the prototyping phase ensured that insights remained relevant and actionable, a hallmark of valid DBR (Garnham, 2024).

By combining iterative design methods with diverse data collection techniques and ongoing stakeholder involvement, this research process achieved high levels of both reliability and validity—forming a strong foundation for the solutions presented in the next chapter.

Limitations

Despite efforts to ensure methodological rigor, the research was subject to several limitations.

Additionally, interviews with gardeners were conducted during a single Open Day event, which may have positively skewed responses due to the festive, communal atmosphere. Language and time constraints also limited deeper follow-up interviews or multi-round testing with users. These factors were mitigated through triangulation, iteration, and continuous client validation.

Ethical Considerations



Ethical integrity was upheld throughout the research and content production phases, in line with professional standards for applied research and user-centered design (Awal, 2023). All survey and interview participants were informed of the project's purpose and voluntarily agreed to participate, either through verbal or implied informed consent, a widely accepted practice in non-sensitive, practice-based fieldwork (Kaiser, 2019).

No personally identifiable information was collected in the survey, and interview transcripts used for internal insights were anonymized. Participant identities were kept confidential in all reporting unless explicit permission was granted.

Particular care was taken with the production of social media content. Interviews filmed during MOES Tuinen's Open Day event involved clear verbal consent before recording. After editing, participants were shown the final cut and asked for a second round of explicit consent before any footage was published. This two-step approach reflects ethical standards in digital storytelling and participatory media, ensuring participant autonomy and accurate representation (Maragh-Bass et al., 2022).

Given the project's low-risk nature and its alignment with ethical norms in design research, formal institutional review was not required. However, best practices in participant rights, privacy, and transparency were consistently applied (Expert, 2024).

2.5 Key Findings & Refined DBR Question

Key Findings Summary

The research phase confirmed and enriched the understanding of four core challenge areas, originally identified through client meetings and contextual analysis. These findings emerged through a triangulated process, drawing from surveys, interviews, observations, and desk research.

1. Brand Awareness

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2. On-site Communication

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3. Staffless Retail Concept

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4. Community & Educational Engagement

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5. Strategic Context & Trend Alignment

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Synthesis & Refined DBR Question

The research phase provided a multi-layered understanding of MOES Tuinen’s challenges as it continues to grow. Each strand of investigation—surveys, interviews, stakeholder conversations, and desk research—pointed toward recurring needs in the areas of communication, visibility, and community engagement. While the original problem framing involved four separate challenges (brand awareness, on-site communication, the staffless store concept, and community education), the prototyping phase naturally gravitated toward solving the most urgent and actionable ones through creative communication and content strategies.

The final interventions—ranging from social media video content and the “Meet the Gardeners” mini-series, to physical communication materials like the cherry tomato grow kits and the pop-up stand at PureMarkt—focused primarily on enhancing MOES Tuinen’s visibility, storytelling, and real-world presence. These solutions helped MOES connect with its diverse and growing audience, particularly within the expat and international community, while maintaining its grassroots, community-driven identity.

Given the outcomes of the research and the direction of the executed deliverables, the refined Design-Based Research question guiding this project is:

How might we use communication design and content strategy to help MOES Tuinen improve brand visibility, user engagement, and community outreach as it scales its services in Amstelveen?



At the same time, **physical marketing** proves just as valuable. The activation of a branded pop-up stand in a popular, high-traffic location (Amstelveen Stadshart) enables MOES Tuinen to connect face-to-face with the local community (Tong, 2024). This stand offers a tangible and personal touchpoint, making the brand more memorable and accessible. It provides free grow kits, flyers, and verbal explanations, creating moments of interaction that deepen audience connection.



Together, **digital** and **physical** strategies enhance user engagement by offering multiple entry points for interaction—online inspiration and in-person activation (Lipschultz, 2020). They also promote community outreach by sparking conversations, encouraging user-generated content, and facilitating word-of-mouth promotion (Solomon, Marshall, & Stuart, 2022). Importantly, this approach helps convert visitors into loyal supporters who advocate for the brand within their networks—an essential asset when scaling operations sustainably (Dwivedi et al., 2020).

For a growing initiative like MOES Tuinen, these strategies are not only effective for attracting attention but also for cultivating lasting relationships and building a strong, value-aligned community.

Sub-Question 1

How might we help MOES Tuinen reach a broader audience—especially expats—and raise awareness about its offerings in an engaging way?

While elements of this question are addressed in the main DBR question, reaching expats specifically requires a focused, culturally aware strategy. The following key areas emerged from the research as effective ways to connect with this audience.

1. Multicultural Events



Expats often attend events that cater to international communities or promote local culture in an accessible way. One such event is Pure Markt, held in Amsterdamse Bos—a large public park near Amstelveen that attracts a diverse audience. Participating in these kinds of events allows MOES Tuinen to increase visibility in multicultural environments where expats are likely to discover new local initiatives (Gemeente Amsterdam, 2024). This approach offers a direct and natural way for expats to encounter MOES Tuinen through informal, lifestyle-oriented experiences.

2. Language Use

Language is a critical component in making a brand feel approachable.



3. Giveaways and User Engagement

(Albert Heijn, 2025)



Giveaways provide a tactile and emotional entry point to brand awareness. Inspired by Albert Heijn's successful "moestuintjes" campaign—which distributed small grow kits to shoppers—MOES Tuinen's grow kit strategy uses the same logic: give people a piece of your brand they can take home, care for, and share (Albert Heijn, 2025). This tactic not only introduces expats to MOES Tuinen's core values (gardening, sustainability, self-sufficiency) but also encourages user-generated content (UGC) and organic word-of-mouth promotion.

By combining



Sub-Question 2

How might we improve MOES Tuinen's on-site communication so that customers receive clear, timely, and accessible updates and instructions?

Clear on-site communication is essential for ensuring a positive customer experience—especially in semi-autonomous environments like MOES Tuinen's greenhouse facilities. The research identified both physical and digital tools that can improve clarity, reduce confusion, and enhance operational efficiency.

Physical Information Boards



At the foundation of effective on-site communication is visibility. Strategically placed information boards at key entry points serve as central hubs for essential updates. These boards display static information such as house rules, safety guidelines, and seasonal tips, while also integrating QR codes that link to digital resources like FAQs, pest alerts, or tutorial videos (Wang & Emurian, 2021). QR-based systems are especially useful because they are low-cost, low-maintenance, and accessible to users with smartphones.

This method ensures that all customers, regardless of their digital literacy or language preference, can access essential information immediately upon arrival. Boards can also be color-coded or icon-driven to improve readability and inclusivity.

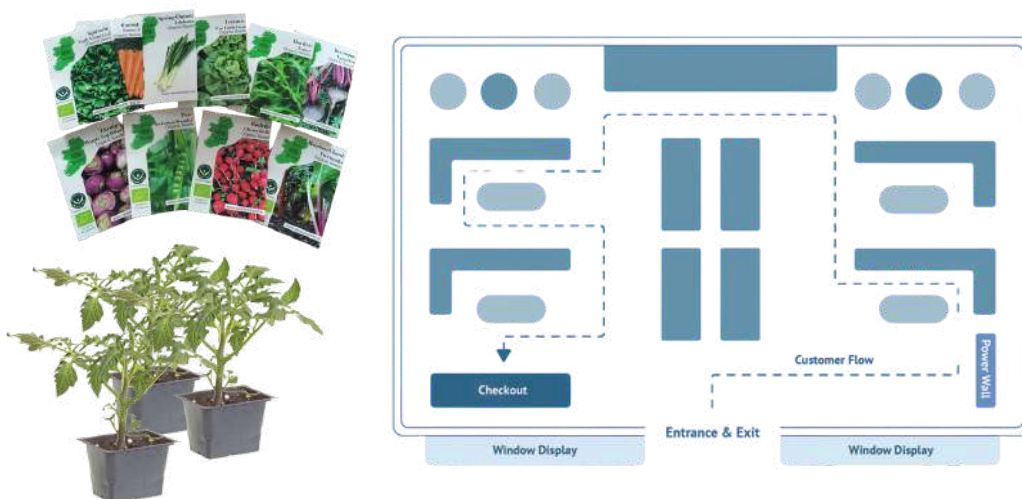
While static boards are effective for general guidance, certain updates—such as weather-sensitive actions, urgent notices, or real-time alerts (e.g., water outages or pest outbreaks)—require a more dynamic system. Research supports the use of digital kiosks or screens that rotate key messages throughout the day (Zhao et al., 2022). These screens could integrate updates from staff or automated sensors (e.g., temperature or humidity triggers) and function as a scalable solution for future expansion.

Sub-Question 3

How might we design a functional, intuitive, and secure staffless self-service store experience for MOES Tuinen?

As MOES Tuinen explores the potential of a staffless self-service store, thoughtful integration of spatial design and technology becomes crucial. A successful store must balance ease of use, aesthetic clarity, and security—all while aligning with the brand's values of sustainability, simplicity, and autonomy.

1. Store Layout & Design



The foundation of a user-friendly staffless store lies in its spatial design. A minimalist layout ensures that customers can navigate the space intuitively, without assistance. Clear signage, logical product groupings, and unobstructed paths contribute to a smooth customer flow and minimize hesitation during the shopping journey (Bitner, 1992). Research supports that well-organized spaces reduce cognitive load and increase customer satisfaction in self-service environments (Marquardt et al., 2021).

For MOES Tuinen, this could include:

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-
-

2. Self-Checkout Technology



A staffless store must also provide a reliable and intuitive payment experience. Self-checkout systems—using QR codes, RFID tags, or NFC-enabled payments like Apple Pay or Google Pay—are increasingly common in retail (Pantano et al., 2020). For MOES Tuinen, this could involve a digital screen or mobile app where customers scan items and pay instantly. Key features include:

- Simple interfaces with clear step-by-step instructions.
- Visual cues and confirmation prompts to reduce errors.
- Option for digital receipts and help buttons.

3. Security & Loss Prevention



Without staff on-site, maintaining trust and safety is critical. Modern self-service stores often use CCTV systems, smart shelf sensors, and automated inventory tracking to prevent loss and ensure accountability (Kumar et al., 2021). Shelf sensors can detect when an item is picked up without being scanned, while entry/exit cameras help monitor store usage.

For MOES Tuinen,



Sub-Question 4

How might we create more opportunities for knowledge sharing, connection, and a stronger sense of community among MOES Tuinen gardeners?

Beyond growing vegetables, MOES Tuinen offers a space for social connection, learning, and community development. Research highlights that community gardening projects are most successful when they foster ongoing interaction and knowledge exchange among participants (Kingsley & Townsend, 2006). The following interventions offer pathways to deepen engagement and build a resilient gardening community.

1. Workshops & Events Space



MOES Tuinen already organizes on-site workshops, such as the well-received session led by Charles Dowding on no-dig gardening techniques.



2. Interactive Learning Station



3. Community Lounge



MOES Tuinen already provides a community lounge area, which serves as a relaxed environment for informal conversation and peer connection.

4. Mentorship Program



A mentorship system could pair experienced gardeners with beginners, offering practical advice, encouragement, and a sense of belonging.



3. Framework Development & Design Criteria

This chapter outlines the ideation and development phase of the project, where insights from research were translated into four distinct conceptual directions—referred to as Design Frames. These frames served as strategic solutions to the challenges uncovered during the research process: increasing brand awareness, improving on-site communication, exploring staffless retail opportunities, and enhancing community engagement through education (Hong et al., 2021).

To support creative ideation, a range of design thinking techniques were applied, including mind mapping, brainstorming, "How Might We" questions, the Value Proposition Canvas, and stakeholder co-creation (Dam & Siang, 2025). These techniques helped transform research data into actionable opportunities and framed each design concept around user needs and organizational goals. For full visuals and detailed documentation of these tools, see **Appendix F p.84-85**.

3.1 Four Design Frames



p.86-p.89

Figure 6

Design Frames

(See **Appendix C** for full-size visual)

To translate research insights into actionable solutions, four design frames were developed—each addressing one of the core challenge areas identified through stakeholder input and user research. These frames represent strategic directions that could be pursued to support MOES Tuinen's goals around brand growth, operational efficiency, user experience, and community engagement (Ronsen, 2025).



3.2 Stakeholder Feedback & Iterations

After developing the four design frames, they were presented to Wouter Kolk, founder of MOES Tuinen, during a dedicated feedback session. Each frame was discussed in relation to MOES's operational realities, long-term goals, and user needs.

Wouter offered detailed feedback on the feasibility, clarity, and potential value of each concept. He highlighted the importance of practicality and short-term impact, particularly given MOES Tuinen's ongoing expansion and limited team capacity. Based on this discussion, two frames emerged as the strongest candidates for further development:

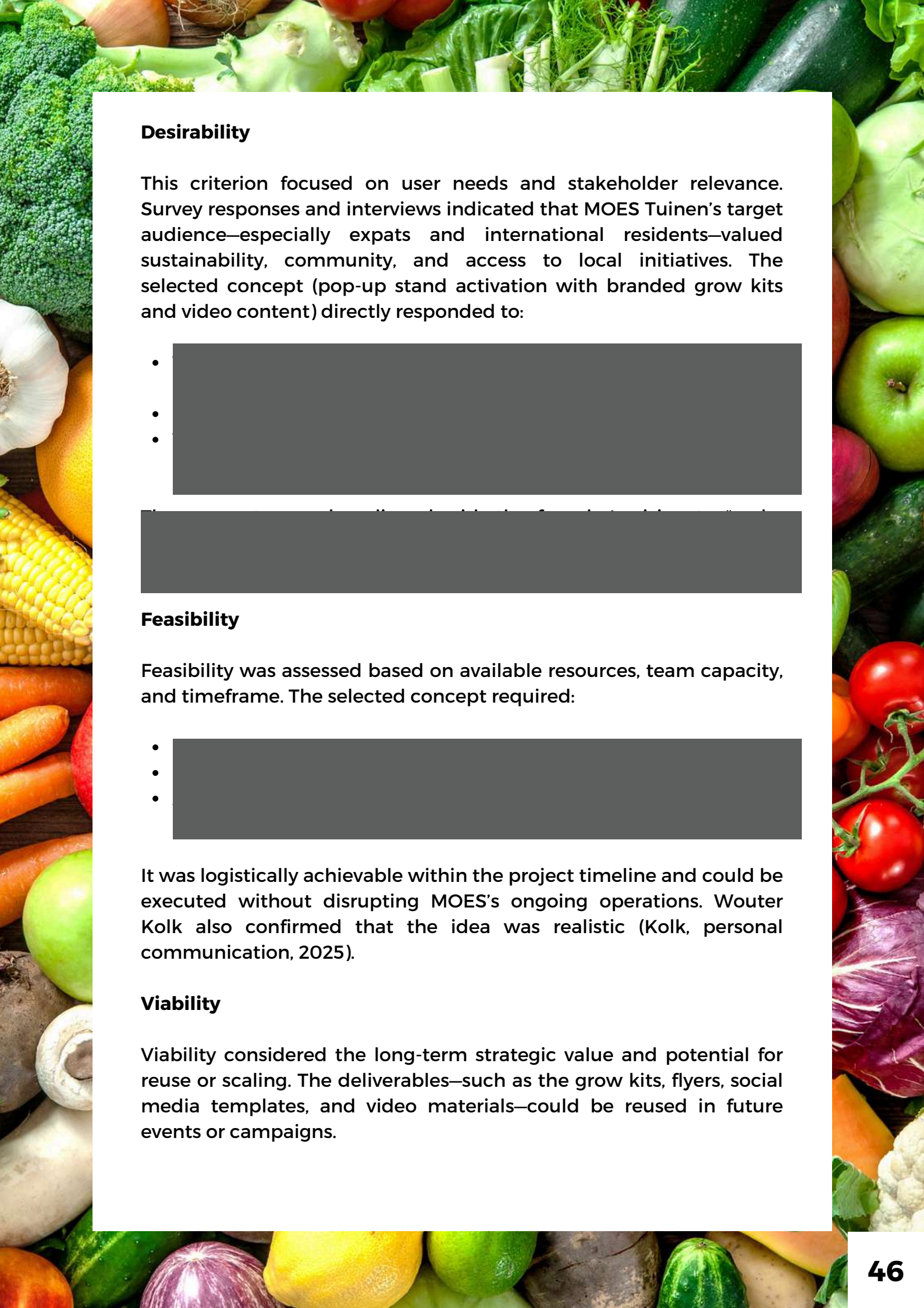
- **Frame 1:** MOES Tuinen Brand Awareness & Pop-up Stand Activation (focused on increasing brand awareness through a pop-up stand and content campaign)
- **Frame 2:** MOES Tuinen Self-Service Store

After weighing the strategic potential of both directions, Wouter gave the project lead full autonomy to select which concept to take forward into prototyping. Following this, **Frame 1** was selected for further development and execution, as it offered a high-impact opportunity to increase visibility, test public engagement strategies, and produce tangible communication materials for MOES Tuinen's growing community.

This selected frame was then refined in detail and iteratively shaped through further stakeholder input and user feedback. The development and testing of that refined concept are covered in the next chapter.

3.3 Design Criteria (Desirability, Feasibility, Viability – DFV)

To evaluate the strength and potential of each design frame—and to guide the selection of the final concept—the DFV framework (Desirability, Feasibility, Viability) was applied. This model helped assess which solution would most effectively balance user needs, operational practicality, and long-term value for MOES Tuinen (Tsui, 2024).



Desirability

This criterion focused on user needs and stakeholder relevance. Survey responses and interviews indicated that MOES Tuinen’s target audience—especially expats and international residents—valued sustainability, community, and access to local initiatives. The selected concept (pop-up stand activation with branded grow kits and video content) directly responded to:

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-
-

Feasibility

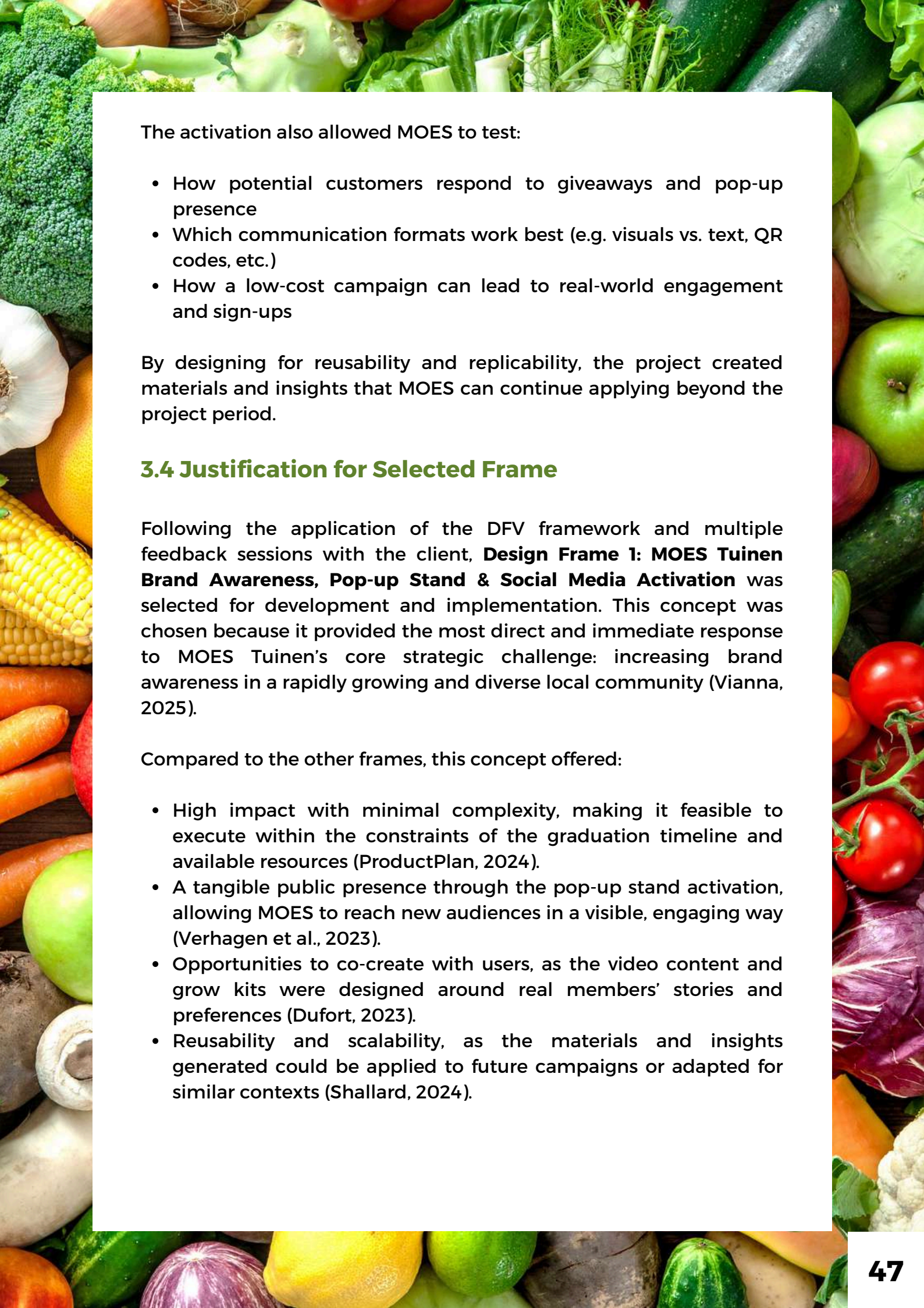
Feasibility was assessed based on available resources, team capacity, and timeframe. The selected concept required:

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It was logistically achievable within the project timeline and could be executed without disrupting MOES’s ongoing operations. Wouter Kolk also confirmed that the idea was realistic (Kolk, personal communication, 2025).

Viability

Viability considered the long-term strategic value and potential for reuse or scaling. The deliverables—such as the grow kits, flyers, social media templates, and video materials—could be reused in future events or campaigns.



The activation also allowed MOES to test:

- How potential customers respond to giveaways and pop-up presence
- Which communication formats work best (e.g. visuals vs. text, QR codes, etc.)
- How a low-cost campaign can lead to real-world engagement and sign-ups

By designing for reusability and replicability, the project created materials and insights that MOES can continue applying beyond the project period.

3.4 Justification for Selected Frame

Following the application of the DFV framework and multiple feedback sessions with the client, **Design Frame 1: MOES Tuinen Brand Awareness, Pop-up Stand & Social Media Activation** was selected for development and implementation. This concept was chosen because it provided the most direct and immediate response to MOES Tuinen's core strategic challenge: increasing brand awareness in a rapidly growing and diverse local community (Vianna, 2025).

Compared to the other frames, this concept offered:

- High impact with minimal complexity, making it feasible to execute within the constraints of the graduation timeline and available resources (ProductPlan, 2024).
- A tangible public presence through the pop-up stand activation, allowing MOES to reach new audiences in a visible, engaging way (Verhagen et al., 2023).
- Opportunities to co-create with users, as the video content and grow kits were designed around real members' stories and preferences (Dufort, 2023).
- Reusability and scalability, as the materials and insights generated could be applied to future campaigns or adapted for similar contexts (Shallard, 2024).

A top-down view of a gardening scene. A silver metal trowel with a wooden handle lies on dark, rich brown soil. To the right of the trowel is a small, green seedling with several leaves. In the upper right corner, a piece of light-colored burlap fabric is visible. A white rectangular box is overlaid on the lower left portion of the image, containing the section header.

4. Concept Development & Testing

This chapter outlines the development, testing, and refinement of the selected concept: “MOES Tuinen Brand Awareness, Pop-up Stand & Social Media Activation.” Chosen from the four proposed design frames, this concept was validated through stakeholder feedback and DFV analysis, and ultimately selected for its potential to improve visibility, engagement, and outreach for MOES Tuinen within both the local and international community.

The concept was shaped into a multi-channel campaign involving a branded pop-up stand, grow kit giveaways, printed flyers, and a bilingual social media series—including a video introduction to MOES Tuinen and a “Meet the Gardeners” mini-interview series. These deliverables were designed to enhance MOES Tuinen’s physical and digital presence while remaining cost-effective, inclusive, and replicable.

Using an iterative approach consistent with the Design-Based Research (DBR) methodology, the concept was translated into a series of low-fidelity prototypes, tested with stakeholders and users, and refined into a fully executed activation. This chapter details the development process, testing insights, and the final justification for the chosen execution.

4.1 Concept Development from Selected Frames



p.86

Figure 7

Design Frame 1

(See Appendix C for full-size visual)

The selected design frame, “MOES Tuinen Brand Awareness, Pop-up Stand & Social Media Activation,” was further developed into a detailed and actionable concept based on stakeholder priorities, user insights, and feasibility constraints. The goal was to create a low-barrier, high-impact activation that could increase visibility for MOES Tuinen and connect with both current and potential members—especially among expats and internationals in Amstelveen.

Drawing from the initial design frame, the concept was broken down into the following core components:

◆ Pop-up Stand Activation

A branded physical presence was designed to bring MOES Tuinen directly into a public setting. Originally intended for Amstelveen Stadshart, the location was shifted to PureMarkt at Amsterdamse Bos for logistical, financial, and timing reasons. The stand featured:

- Branded signage
- A welcoming setup with decorated grow kits
- Distribution of flyers and planting instructions
- Direct engagement with passersby

This component aimed to build visibility and start real-world conversations with people unfamiliar with MOES.

◆ Grow Kit Giveaways

Custom-designed cherry tomato grow kits were produced as part of the activation. Each kit included:

- A soil tablet
- A packet of cherry tomato seeds
- A printed infographic with planting instructions, visuals, and a QR code linking to MOES content

The kits served as both a marketing tool and an educational resource, aligning with MOES's mission to promote sustainable gardening.

◆ Social Media Content

To extend the campaign digitally, a series of social media deliverables were created:

- A video introducing MOES Tuinen, featuring an interview with Wouter Kolk and footage from the Open Day
- A five-part "Meet the Gardeners" mini-series, showcasing short interviews with real members
- A final video recap summarizing the entire activation process, with voiceover and visual highlights

These materials were posted on MOES's Facebook and Instagram accounts, and the intro video was also used as a sponsored ad to reach new audiences.

◆ Flyers & Printed Materials

A vibrant, illustration-led flyer was designed to introduce MOES Tuinen in a clear and approachable way. It included:

- A warm visual of a diverse group of gardeners working together
- The tagline: "Your own garden, in the comfort of a greenhouse"
- A QR code linking to the website
- Contact details including MOES Tuinen's Instagram, Facebook, and physical address

This multi-pronged concept was developed collaboratively with feedback from Wouter Kolk and refined through several iterations, forming the foundation for the prototyping and testing detailed in the next section.

4.2 Low-Fidelity Prototypes & Testing

Before final implementation, each element of the “MOES Tuinen Brand Awareness, Pop-up Stand & Social Media Activation” concept was developed as a low-fidelity prototype and tested twice through targeted a user survey. Feedback was gathered from the target audience via an online questionnaire and informal testing sessions to evaluate clarity, tone, and usability.

Testing focused on how well each component aligned with MOES Tuinen’s brand identity, communication goals, and user expectations. Results from the survey are included in **Appendix H p.90**.

The prototyping process followed the principles of Design-Based Research (DBR), emphasizing quick iteration, real-world insight, and evidence-informed development.

1. Pop-up Stand Concept & Location Testing



p.92

Figure 8

Pop-up stand
low & mid fidelity
prototype

(See **Appendix H**
for full-size visual)

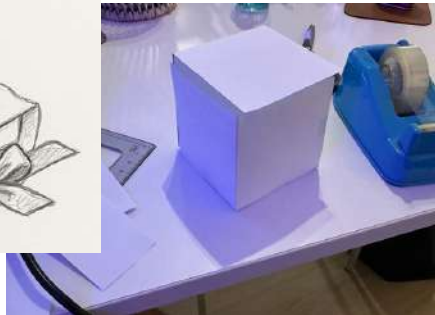
Low-fidelity & mid-fidelity prototypes: Sketch mock-up of a compact pop-up stand (figure 8).

2. Grow Kit Format & Seed Selection

p.93



First test



Second test

Figure 9

Grow Kit
low & mid fidelity
prototypes

(See **Appendix I** for
full-size visual)

Two low-fidelity prototypes were created (figure 9) to explore the form and presentation of the MOES Tuinen grow kit giveaway. The first was a hand-drawn sketch featuring a sunflower sprouting from a branded container, visualizing the concept as a friendly, gift-like item. The second was a real-life paper box prototype, assembled using white paper and tape to test scale, layout, and usability. Together, these early models helped validate the grow kit's design, portability, and visual appeal before final production.

3. Flyer

p.94



Figure 10

Grow Kit
low fidelity
prototype

(See **Appendix I** for
full-size visual)

This low-fidelity flyer prototype (figure 10) is a hand-drawn wireframe sketch designed to visualize the key layout and content structure for the MOES Tuinen promotional flyer. It includes placeholder elements such as a bold header, visual space for an image, bullet points for core messages (e.g., how to get involved), and contact details including a QR code, website, and Instagram handle.

4.3 Iterations Based on Feedback

The following are iterations decided for the final high-fi prototype/product per deliverable based on the user testing:

1. Pop-up Stand Concept & Location Testing

The original location proposed for the pop-up stand was Amstelveen Stadshart, but after evaluating permit restrictions, budget constraints, and timeline limitations, the prototype was reoriented toward PureMarkt at Amsterdamse Bos. This alternative was suggested by Wouter Kolk and later validated through discussion, as it offered a better fit with the project timeline and provided a stronger balance between reach and feasibility (Kolk, personal communication, 2025).

Feedback (via user testing):

“It’s clean but looks a bit too corporate—can you make it feel more organic or handmade?”

“I’m not sure what MOES Tuinen is just from the front view.”

To-be-implemented in the final version:

- Soft green tones and full-width imagery to add warmth and a natural feel.
- Clear tagline: “Your own garden, in the comfort of a greenhouse.”
- Front-facing QR code and address handle for accessibility and instant brand connection.

2. Grow Kit Format & Seed Selection

Feedback (via user testing):

- “Tomatoes are easier and feel more rewarding to grow.”
- “Would be great if it worked even without a garden—I live in an apartment.”

To-be-implemented in the final version:

- Switched to cherry tomato seeds—specifically a compact variety suitable for small indoor spaces and balcony pots.
- Instructions kept in English only, since the target audience for this activation was primarily expats.
- Clear visual steps, bold headings, and a scannable QR code linking to additional planting content.

3. Flyers

Feedback (via user testing):

“Looks nice but I’d prefer more images or icons.”

“Too much reading—can you highlight the key info?”

To-be-implemented in the final version:

- Redesigned with stronger visuals, concise messaging, and key sections broken down clearly.
- Optimized layout for clarity and engagement with international visitors.
- Prominent contact information, web address, and a QR code for quick access.

4.4 Final Concept Justification

The final concept—MOES Tuinen Brand Awareness, Pop-up Stand & Social Media Activation—was selected and executed based on its strong alignment with both the research insights and the core objectives of the client. It successfully addressed the primary challenges identified during the research phase: limited brand awareness, lack of visual and multilingual communication, and the need for broader outreach among expats and newcomers in Amstelveen.

This concept stood out for several key reasons:

Strategic Alignment



Practical Feasibility



User-Centered Design



Long-Term Value



A high-angle photograph of a vast tea plantation. The tea bushes are arranged in neat, horizontal rows that stretch across the landscape. Several workers, wearing traditional conical hats and carrying woven baskets, are scattered throughout the field, engaged in harvesting the tea leaves. The scene is captured in bright daylight, highlighting the vibrant green of the tea plants and the earthy tones of the workers' clothing and hats.

5. Final Design, Execution & Deliverables

A lush green tea plantation with rows of tea bushes. In the background, several people wearing traditional conical hats are working in the fields. The scene is bright and sunny, with the tea leaves appearing vibrant green.

This chapter presents the final implementation of the selected concept: MOES Tuinen Brand Awareness, Pop-up Stand & Social Media Activation. Following several iterations and rounds of feedback, the refined concept was executed across both physical and digital touchpoints to engage MOES's diverse target audience and support the organization's visibility goals.

The project culminated in a series of deliverables developed in close collaboration with the client and informed by user insights. These include a bilingual customer survey, communication materials such as flyers and grow kit instructions, and a complete activation of the pop-up stand at PureMarkt in Amsterdamse Bos. Additionally, a suite of social media content was created—including a recap video with voiceover and the “Meet the Gardeners” mini-series—designed to extend the campaign's reach online.

This chapter provides an overview of the final concept, a detailed list of the deliverables, insights from user testing and stakeholder feedback, and an evaluation of the solution using the DFV framework (Desirability, Feasibility, Viability).

5.1 Overview of Final Concept & Deliverables

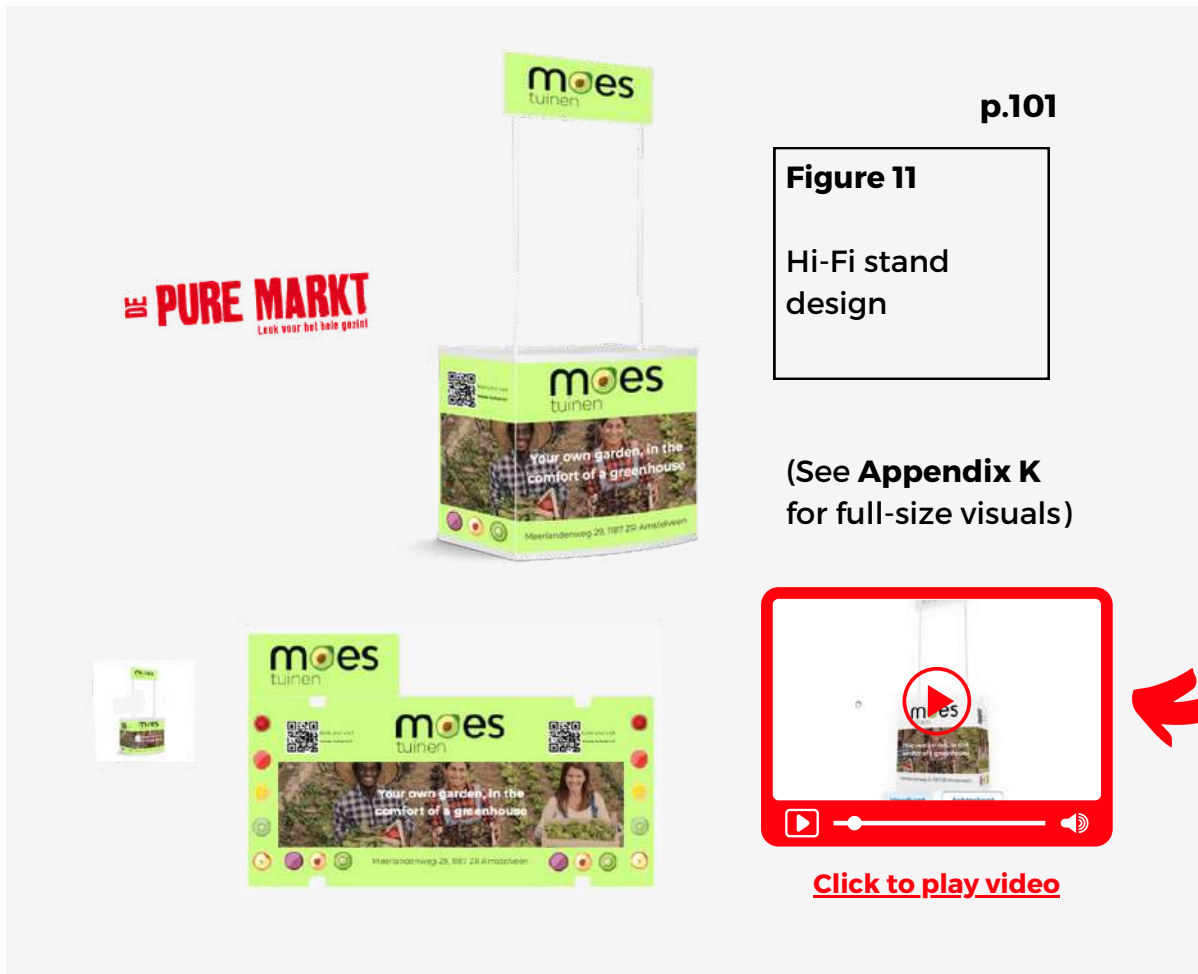
The final concept—MOES Tuinen Brand Awareness, Pop-up Stand & Social Media Activation—was executed as a multi-touchpoint communication strategy designed to enhance visibility, engage new audiences, and share MOES Tuinen's values in a compelling and accessible way.

Rooted in the selected design frame and refined through iterative feedback, the concept blended physical activation with digital storytelling to create a unified brand experience. The approach focused on reaching MOES's multicultural and multilingual audience through both on-site engagement and online presence—while staying feasible within the available budget, timeframe, and resources.

For a detailed breakdown of **project timeline**, **deliverables**, and **budget**, see the full project budget and deliverables overview in **Appendix J p. 95 - p.100** or refer to the document titled “Moes Tuinen – Deliverables, Project Timeline & Budget.”

Key Deliverables

1. Pop-up Stand Activation @ PureMarkt



Executed on **May 18, 2025**, at PureMarkt (Amsterdamse Bos), the branded pop-up stand served as a central physical touchpoint. Volunteers distributed flyers and grow kits, interacted with attendees, and helped communicate MOES Tuinen's mission around sustainability and community. The modular stand setup featured signage, branded materials, and product displays—all designed for reusability and visual alignment with MOES's identity. The design was built online through the platform of PixartPrinting (2025).

Importantly, three MOES Tuinen members volunteered to help at the stand, responding to an earlier survey question about interest in supporting the activation. Their involvement added authenticity, strengthened community representation, and enhanced real-time engagement with visitors.

2. Flyer



p.102

Figure 13

Flyer

(See **Appendix K** for full-size visual)

A simplified flyer was handed out at the pop-up event to introduce MOES Tuinen to new audiences. It featured the tagline “Your own garden, in the comfort of a greenhouse,” along with key contact details including the Instagram handle, physical address, and website. The flyer was designed with a clean and minimal layout to ensure clarity, visual appeal, and alignment with MOES Tuinen’s brand identity—serving as a quick and accessible entry point for curious passersby.

3. Grow Kits + Printed Materials



Figure 14

Grow Kit creation

(See **Appendix K** for full-size visuals)

p.10-104

[Click to play video](#)

Custom-designed cherry tomato grow kits were distributed during the event. Each kit included:

- A soil tablet
- A biodegradable seed packet + biodegradable cellulose pot
- An English-language instructional guide

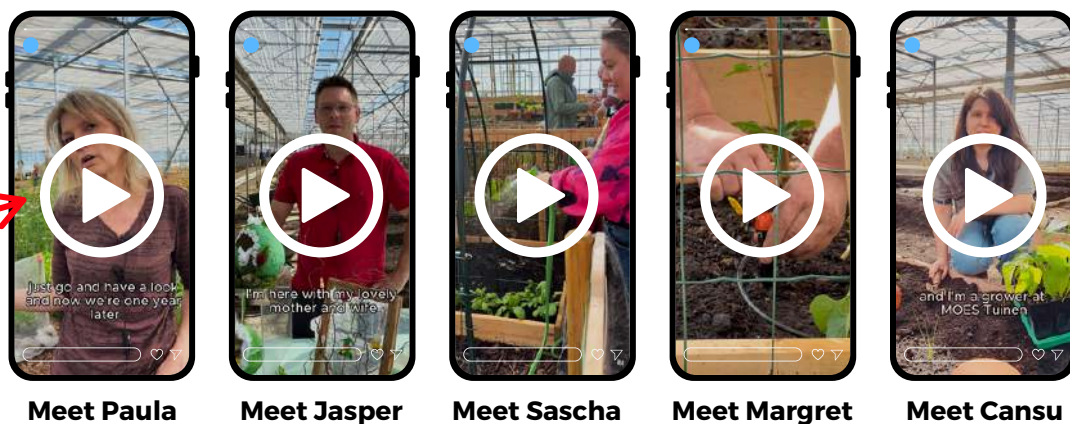
4. Social Media Campaign

To amplify the campaign digitally, a series of social media videos and assets were produced and published across MOES Tuinen's Instagram and Facebook channels. The goal was to extend the reach of the activation, highlight real community voices, and engage audiences beyond the physical event.

“Meet the Gardeners” Video Series



Click on each video to play it



This five-part mini-series featured short interviews with actual MOES members, offering viewers a personal and authentic glimpse into the community. Each video highlighted:

- Personal gardening stories
- Cultural backgrounds
- The community-building spirit of MOES Tuinen
- A dedicated hashtag was used: #TeamMOESTuinen as encourages user-generated content, and boosts online visibility by uniting posts under a recognizable brand identity (Gillian, 2024).

The videos were optimized for mobile viewing, subtitled for accessibility, and accompanied by soft background music. Their casual tone and real-life storytelling reflected MOES's warm, inclusive identity and helped humanize the brand for online audiences.

Introduction Video with Wouter Kolk



A short-form video interview with MOES Tuinen's founder, Wouter Kolk, was filmed and edited to introduce the organization's mission, values, and services to new audiences. The video was published across MOES Tuinen's Instagram and Facebook accounts, where it received over 9,000 views and was also repurposed as a sponsored video ad—effectively driving awareness and engagement among the target audience. One of the key reasons for the video's high reach was the proactive outreach campaign: a list of relevant Instagram accounts—both high- and low-profile within the gardening niche—was compiled, and personalized messages were sent to each, explaining the project and kindly asking them to share the video. This targeted peer-to-peer strategy helped amplify visibility beyond MOES Tuinen's existing followers and into new, engaged communities.

Recap Video with Voiceover



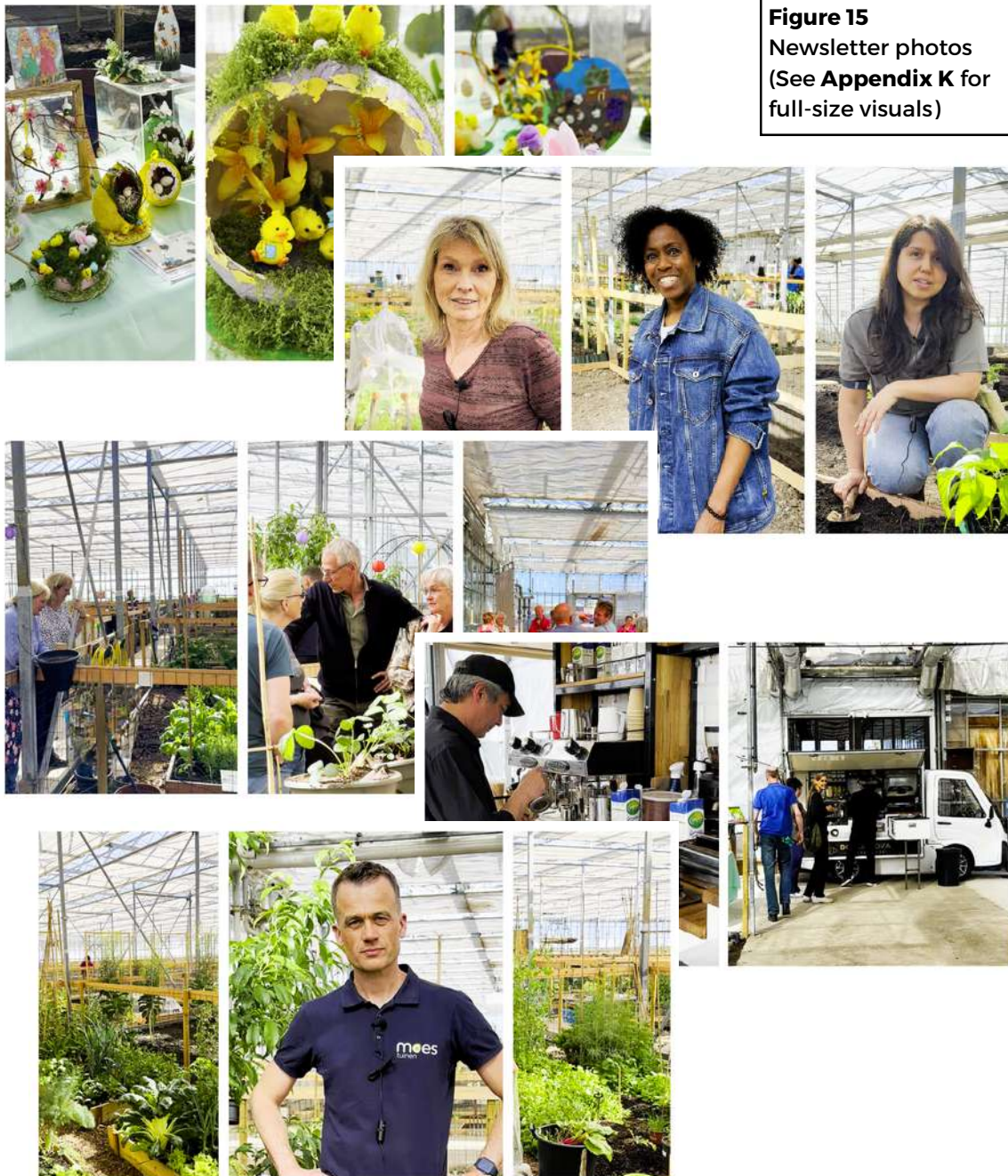
A final compilation video was also created to summarize the entire project—from the Open Day to the PureMarkt activation. Featuring a voiceover and personal reflections, the video provided a polished yet approachable narrative of the full journey and was used to showcase the project's impact and outcomes through MOES Tuinen's social channels.

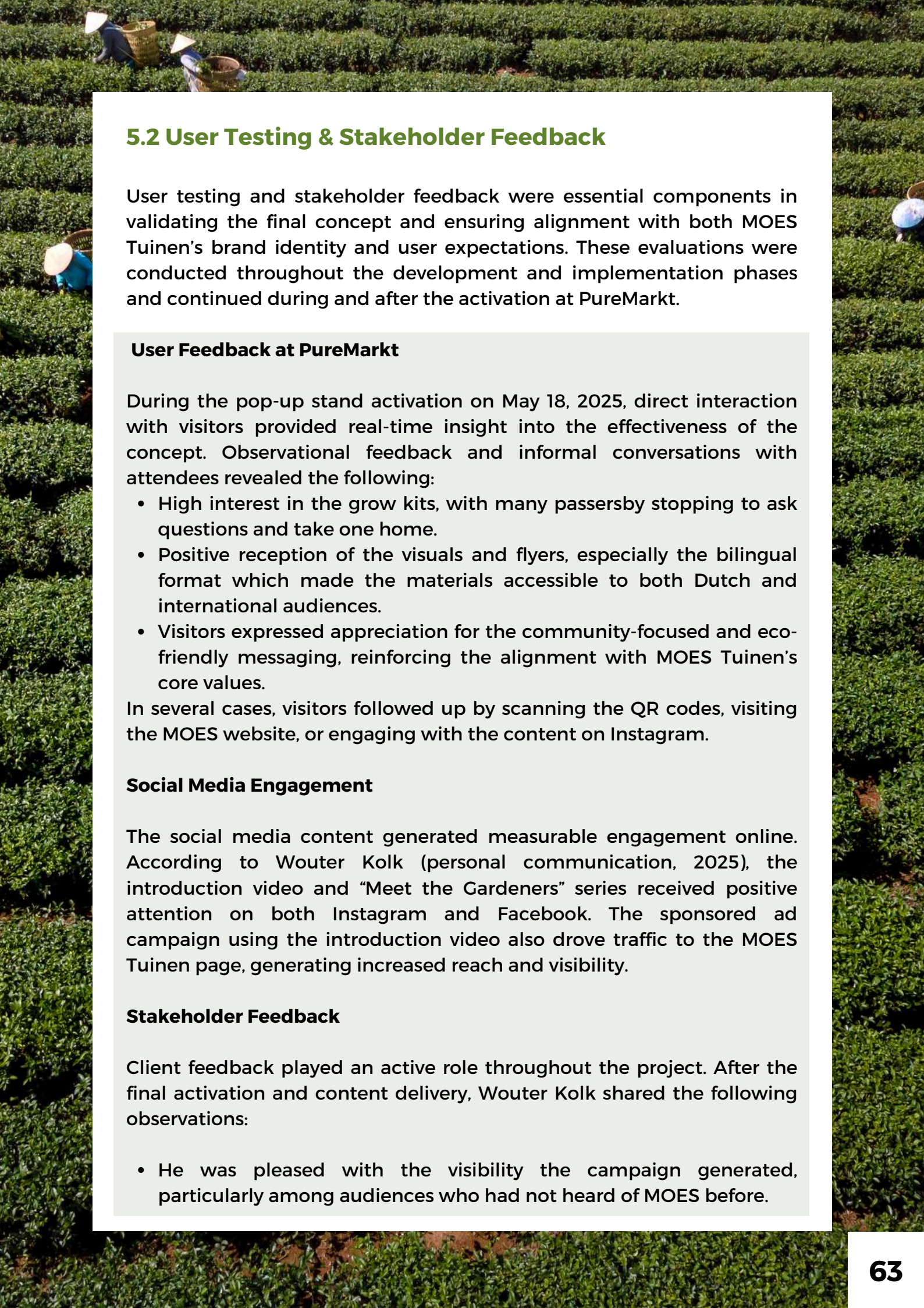
5. Photos for Newsletter Email

A selection of edited photos captured during the MOES Tuinen Open Day was provided to the client for inclusion in their monthly newsletter. These images were used in a news brief to highlight the recent activation and visually engage the existing community through email communication.

p.105 - p.107

Figure 15
Newsletter photos
(See **Appendix K** for
full-size visuals)



A background image of a lush green tea plantation with rows of tea bushes. In the upper left, two workers wearing traditional conical hats are visible, one holding a basket. The scene is bright and sunny.

5.2 User Testing & Stakeholder Feedback

User testing and stakeholder feedback were essential components in validating the final concept and ensuring alignment with both MOES Tuinen's brand identity and user expectations. These evaluations were conducted throughout the development and implementation phases and continued during and after the activation at PureMarkt.

User Feedback at PureMarkt

During the pop-up stand activation on May 18, 2025, direct interaction with visitors provided real-time insight into the effectiveness of the concept. Observational feedback and informal conversations with attendees revealed the following:

- High interest in the grow kits, with many passersby stopping to ask questions and take one home.
- Positive reception of the visuals and flyers, especially the bilingual format which made the materials accessible to both Dutch and international audiences.
- Visitors expressed appreciation for the community-focused and eco-friendly messaging, reinforcing the alignment with MOES Tuinen's core values.

In several cases, visitors followed up by scanning the QR codes, visiting the MOES website, or engaging with the content on Instagram.

Social Media Engagement

The social media content generated measurable engagement online. According to Wouter Kolk (personal communication, 2025), the introduction video and "Meet the Gardeners" series received positive attention on both Instagram and Facebook. The sponsored ad campaign using the introduction video also drove traffic to the MOES Tuinen page, generating increased reach and visibility.

Stakeholder Feedback

Client feedback played an active role throughout the project. After the final activation and content delivery, Wouter Kolk shared the following observations:

- He was pleased with the visibility the campaign generated, particularly among audiences who had not heard of MOES before.

- The videos helped tell MOES's story in a more personal and emotional way, something he believed was previously missing.
- The grow kits and flyers were appreciated as low-cost but effective tools for outreach that could be replicated in future activations.
- He noted that the project gave him new ideas about visual branding, multilingual content, and social media formats (Kolk, personal communication, 2025).

Together, these user and stakeholder responses validated the success of the final concept and confirmed that the solution addressed key pain points identified during the research phase.

5.3 Evaluation Against DFV Criteria

To assess the overall effectiveness of the final concept, the Desirability-Feasibility-Viability (DFV) framework was used. This model is widely applied in design thinking to evaluate whether a solution is appealing to users, realistic to implement, and sustainable over time.

Desirability

To what extent do users and stakeholders want this solution?

The concept responded directly to MOES Tuinen's audience needs and communication gaps.

- The pop-up activation and grow kit giveaway attracted attention and encouraged public interaction.
- The social media videos provided emotional storytelling that showcased the community and sparked interest.
- Survey insights confirmed users' preference for visual, multilingual communication and community-focused initiatives.
- Client and user feedback consistently praised the campaign's tone, accessibility, and relevance.



Feasibility

Can this solution be implemented within the given resources, time, and constraints?

- The campaign was designed and executed within a limited budget and timeframe.
- All materials were independently created using accessible tools, and the PureMarkt location was chosen for its logistical and financial practicality.
- Flyers, grow kits, and video content were all scalable and adaptable, with minimal dependency on external suppliers or platforms.



Effectively met

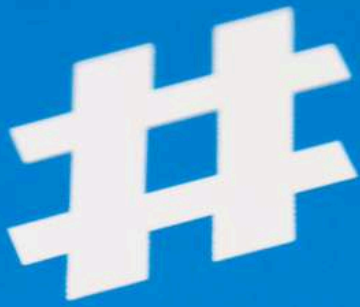
Viability

Does the solution create long-term value and opportunities for scaling or repetition?

- The final deliverables—especially the social media content and grow kit template—are reusable and adaptable for future campaigns or seasonal events.
- The activation format (stand + giveaway + content) provides a replicable outreach model for future use by MOES Tuinen at other community markets or local events.
- Importantly, the event also led to an unexpected but valuable realization for the client: four MOES Tuinen members volunteered to support the activation by distributing grow kits and flyers, sharing their personal experiences, and representing the organization on-site. This highlighted an underutilized strength—MOES's loyal and enthusiastic community—which could be mobilized for future outreach and brand ambassadorship.
- This experience opened the client's eyes to the latent potential of community members as grassroots promoters, reinforcing the community-driven nature of the brand.



Viable for long-term engagement and growth



6.

Social Media Strategy & Future Recommendations

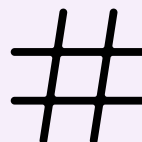
As MOES Tuinen continues to grow its presence in Amstelveen—now operating on over 15,000 m² of space—it faces increasing opportunities to connect with a broader audience through digital channels. This chapter presents a strategic social media plan grounded in the research findings and campaign experience from this project.

Drawing on survey data, field observations, and the success of the “Meet the Gardeners” and pop-up activation campaign, the strategy outlined here aims to guide MOES Tuinen in leveraging platforms like Instagram and Facebook more effectively. The approach emphasizes community storytelling, multilingual content, and consistency—ensuring the brand remains accessible, engaging, and rooted in its values.

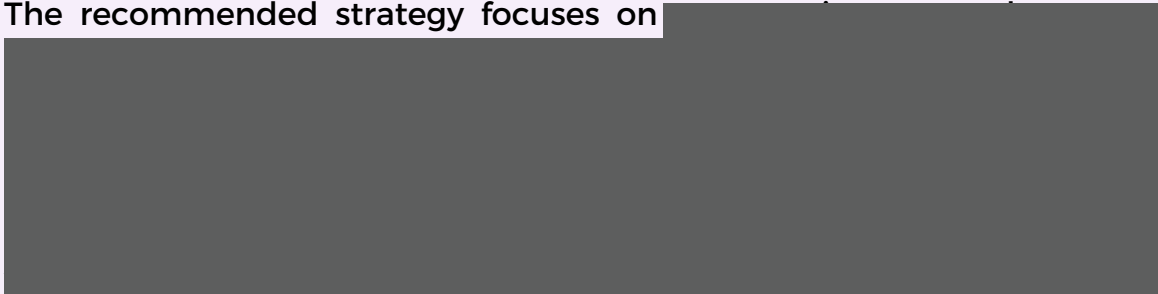
This chapter also provides specific content ideas, platform strategies, hashtag guidance, and actionable recommendations to support long-term brand awareness and community growth.

Summary of Strategic Findings

Key insights revealed that



The recommended strategy focuses on



Full platform strategies, content ideas, hashtag lists, visual guidelines, and implementation recommendations can be found in **Appendix L p.108 - p.115.**



7. Conclusion & Reflection

This final chapter offers a summary of the project's impact, key insights gained, and personal reflections on the design-based research (DBR) process. Beyond delivering communication tools and social media content, the project aimed to support MOES Tuinen's strategic growth and deepen its engagement with a diverse, community-oriented audience.

Through real-world testing, stakeholder collaboration, and creative experimentation, the project not only generated practical outcomes but also highlighted broader lessons about sustainable branding, grassroots communication, and participatory design. The following sections reflect on the tangible impact for MOES Tuinen, lessons learned throughout the process, and a personal evaluation of how the DBR methodology shaped the development and execution of this graduation project.

7.1 Impact on MOES Tuinen

The graduation project delivered a measurable and lasting impact on MOES Tuinen by providing the organization with professional communication tools, visual content, and an activation concept that enhanced its visibility, community connection, and digital presence.

Enhanced Brand Awareness

The core objective of increasing awareness—particularly among internationals and younger audiences—was addressed through a bilingual communication strategy that included a visually branded pop-up stand, flyers, and social media content. The introduction video and the “Meet the Gardener” mini-series were shared across Instagram and Facebook and later used as part of a sponsored ad campaign, which helped MOES Tuinen reach new potential customers in the Amstelveen area.

Strengthened Digital Presence

The project helped the organization articulate its story through authentic, human-centered content, emphasizing MOES's community values and sustainability mission. By creating visual and emotional content grounded in real stories, the brand gained new digital assets that can be repurposed and expanded in future campaigns.

Realization of Volunteer Potential

The activation day at PureMarkt revealed an unexpected internal strength: MOES Tuinen's members were not only willing to volunteer but were enthusiastic brand ambassadors. Four members joined the pop-up stand voluntarily to distribute grow kits, engage with the public, and share their experiences. This was an eye-opening moment for the client, highlighting the latent potential for grassroots advocacy within the existing community.

Practical Tools for Replication

MOES Tuinen now possesses a replicable outreach model—consisting of a pop-up concept, design materials, instructional content, and a format for community-driven storytelling. These resources and templates can be reused for future events, partnerships, or seasonal campaigns, enabling long-term strategic use beyond the scope of this project. Overall, the project provided both immediate value through brand activation and strategic insights that can guide MOES Tuinen's growth in the coming years.

7.2 Lessons Learned

Throughout this project, several key lessons emerged—both from a strategic communication perspective and from working within a design-based research (DBR) framework. These insights shaped the direction of the concept, improved the quality of the deliverables, and offered valuable takeaways for future projects involving real-world clients and social impact organizations.

1. The Importance of Co-Creation

Collaborating closely with the client proved to be essential. Regular feedback sessions with MOES Tuinen's founder helped refine the design direction and ensured alignment with the organization's goals and realities. Co-creation also strengthened the final outcome, as the client's insights helped adapt the deliverables to the practical limitations and opportunities of the brand.

2. Research-Driven Design Delivers Clarity

The decision to use user surveys, stakeholder feedback, and design thinking techniques early in the process paid off. It provided clarity on what users needed, what they cared about, and how communication could be improved—ensuring that the final concept was not just creative, but grounded in actual user behavior and stakeholder needs.

3. Testing Is Invaluable

Executing the pop-up stand at PureMarkt transformed abstract ideas into tangible results. It provided real-world feedback, revealed new opportunities (like the strength of MOES's volunteer base), and exposed practical considerations that could not have been predicted in a purely theoretical setting.

4. Flexibility Is a Strength

While the original idea was to activate the pop-up in Stadshart Amstelveen, logistical and budgetary constraints led to a pivot toward PureMarkt. This shift not only made the project more feasible, but also opened up new audience exposure and connections. Being flexible with the execution plan made the outcome stronger and more realistic.

5. Simplicity Works Best

From communication style to visual content, simple, clear, and friendly formats worked best—especially for diverse audiences including non-Dutch speakers and first-time gardeners. Overly complex materials or heavy text risked alienating the very people MOES Tuinen aims to attract.

These lessons will be directly applicable to future projects involving client collaboration, creative problem-solving, and community-driven design.

7.3 Personal Reflection on the DBR Process

Working through the Design-Based Research (DBR) methodology offered both a challenging and rewarding experience. It required balancing academic rigor with creative flexibility, while continuously adapting to real-world feedback, time constraints, and unexpected developments. Through this process, several key reflections emerged.

Embracing Iteration as a Strength

Initially, it was tempting to move quickly from concept to execution. However, DBR taught me the value of slowing down to test, reflect, and iterate. By involving stakeholders at each stage and responding to feedback with revised designs or questions, the final outcome became far more aligned with user needs and the client's goals. This iterative mindset strengthened both the project's quality and its relevance.

Applying Thinking Techniques with Purpose

Utilizing tools like mind mapping, "How Might We" questions, and the Value Proposition Canvas helped structure abstract challenges into tangible design directions. These thinking techniques gave structure to creativity and made the research-to-concept process more manageable—especially when working with multiple problem areas simultaneously.

Navigating Real-World Constraints

This project reinforced that real-world creative work rarely unfolds in a straight line. From budget limitations to tight timelines, flexibility was essential. Adjusting the activation plan (from Stadshart to PureMarkt) or reworking design materials last-minute required problem-solving and adaptability—skills that are just as important as ideation.

The Power of Real Impact

The most rewarding part of this experience was seeing tangible results and real engagement from both the client and the MOES Tuinen community. Whether it was feedback from users during the pop-up activation, or volunteers stepping forward to represent the brand, the project proved that well-designed communication can genuinely inspire action.

The DBR process encouraged a deeper level of thinking, fostered a more human-centered approach, and delivered results that went beyond academic exercise. It was not only a graduation requirement, but also a meaningful stepping stone in my growth as a creative strategist.

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Appendices

G: Design Frames

Design Frame #1

Name: Moes Tuinen Brand Awareness & Pop-up Stand Activation

Tagline: Bringing Moes Tuinen to You

Value Proposition (If... then... Statement):

If Moes Tuinen implements a pop-up stand activation combined with a digital marketing strategy, then brand awareness will increase, attracting more customers and fostering stronger community engagement while reaching a wider audience.

Stakeholder(s):

- Primary Audience: Potential customers, expats, local residents.
- Secondary Audience: Moes Tuinen management, social media audience, local businesses.

Description:

- Pop-up Stand at Amstelveen Stadshart: A branded stand with brochures, flyers, QR codes, and a digital display to engage visitors.
- Moestuintjes Seed Giveaway: Free seed kits with QR codes and gardening tips to encourage community engagement.
- Social Media Video Content: Short, shareable videos featuring community stories and event highlights to boost online visibility.

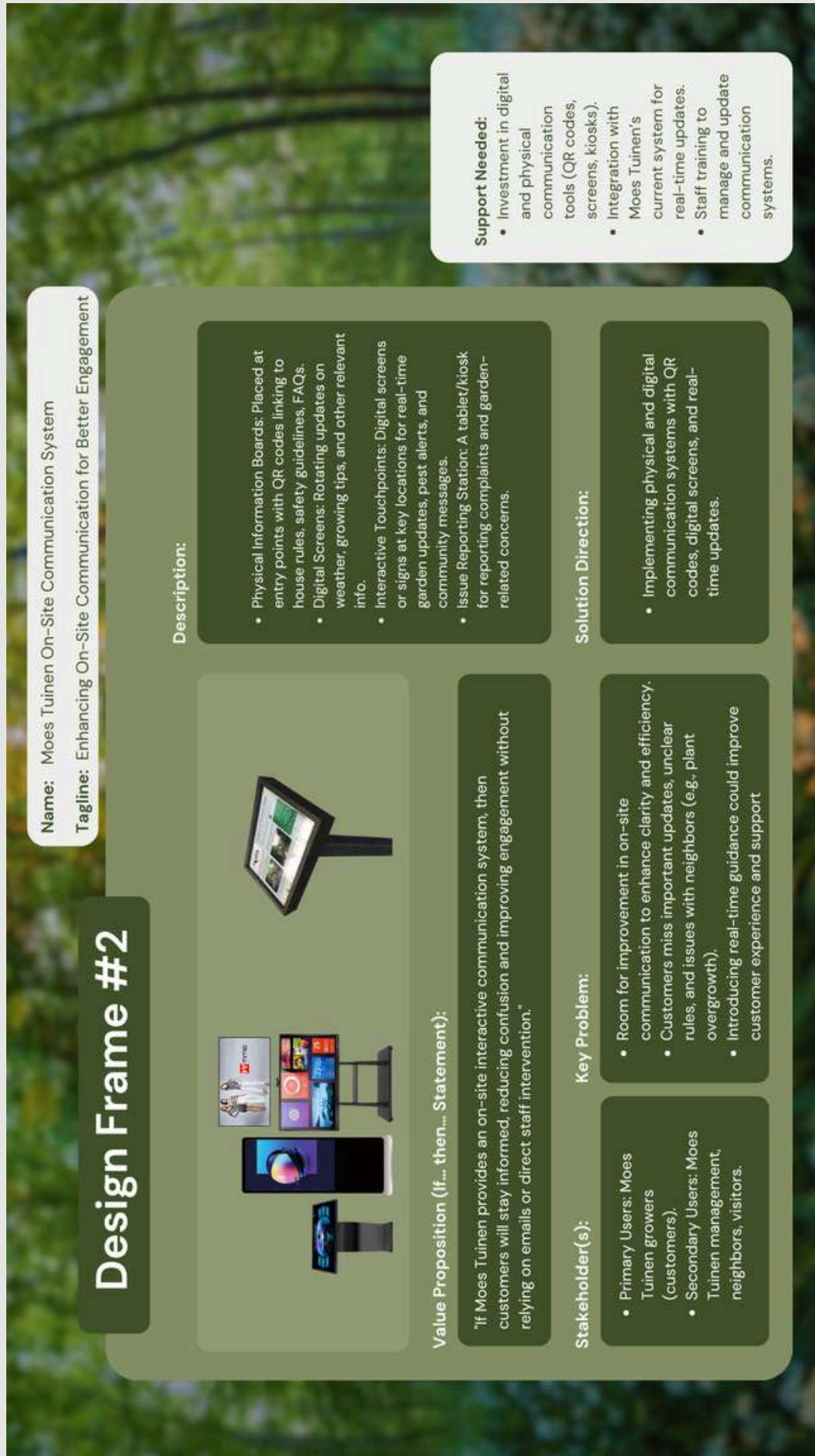
Solution Direction:

Pop-up stand activation at Amstelveen Stadshart with brochures, interactive materials, and a seed giveaway. Supported by social media content and QR-linked resources to boost engagement and brand awareness.

Support Needed:

- Funding for the pop-up stand and promotional materials.
- Content creation for videos and social media campaigns.
- Partnerships with local influencers and businesses?

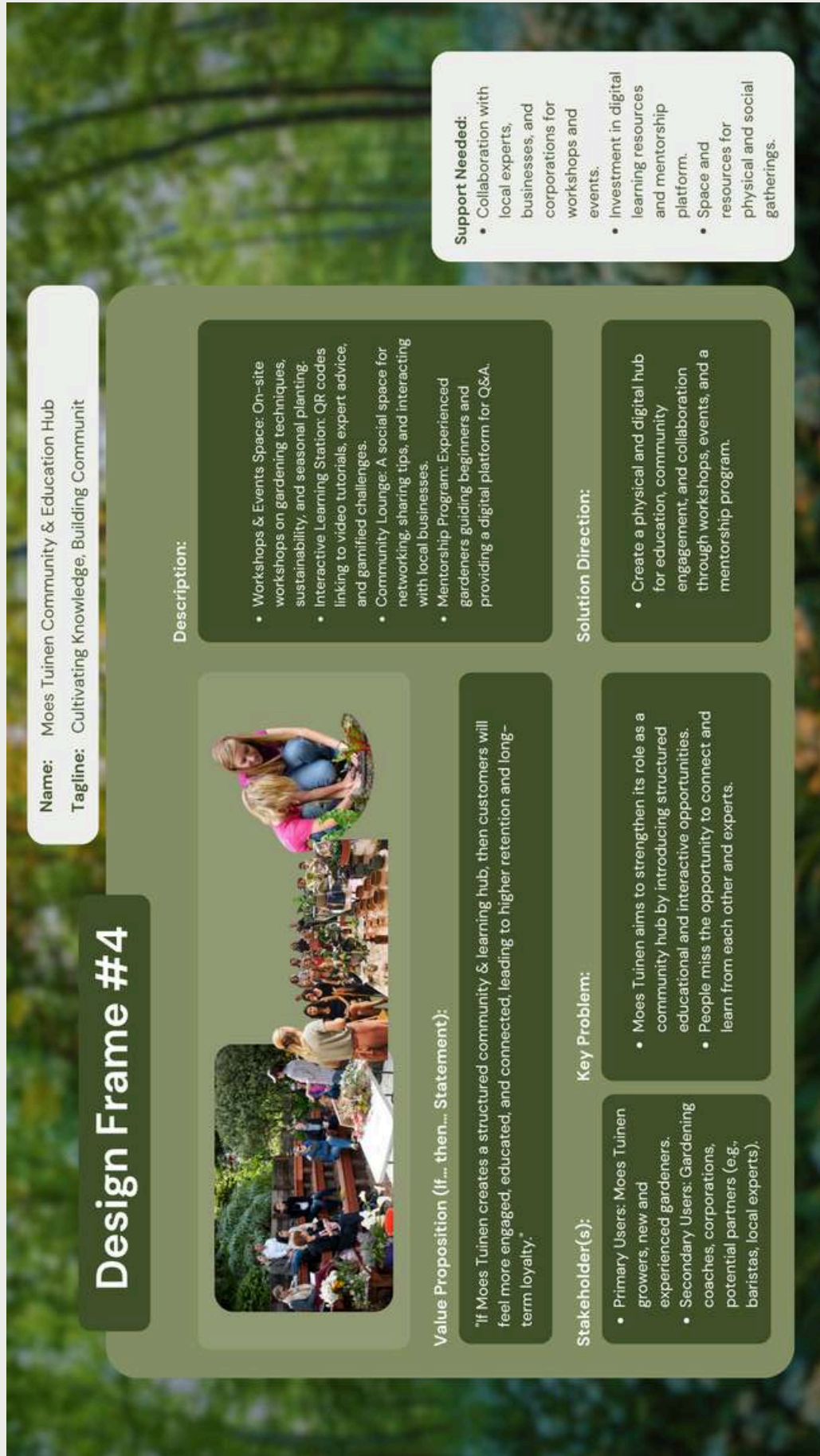
G: Design Frames



G: Design Frames



G: Design Frames

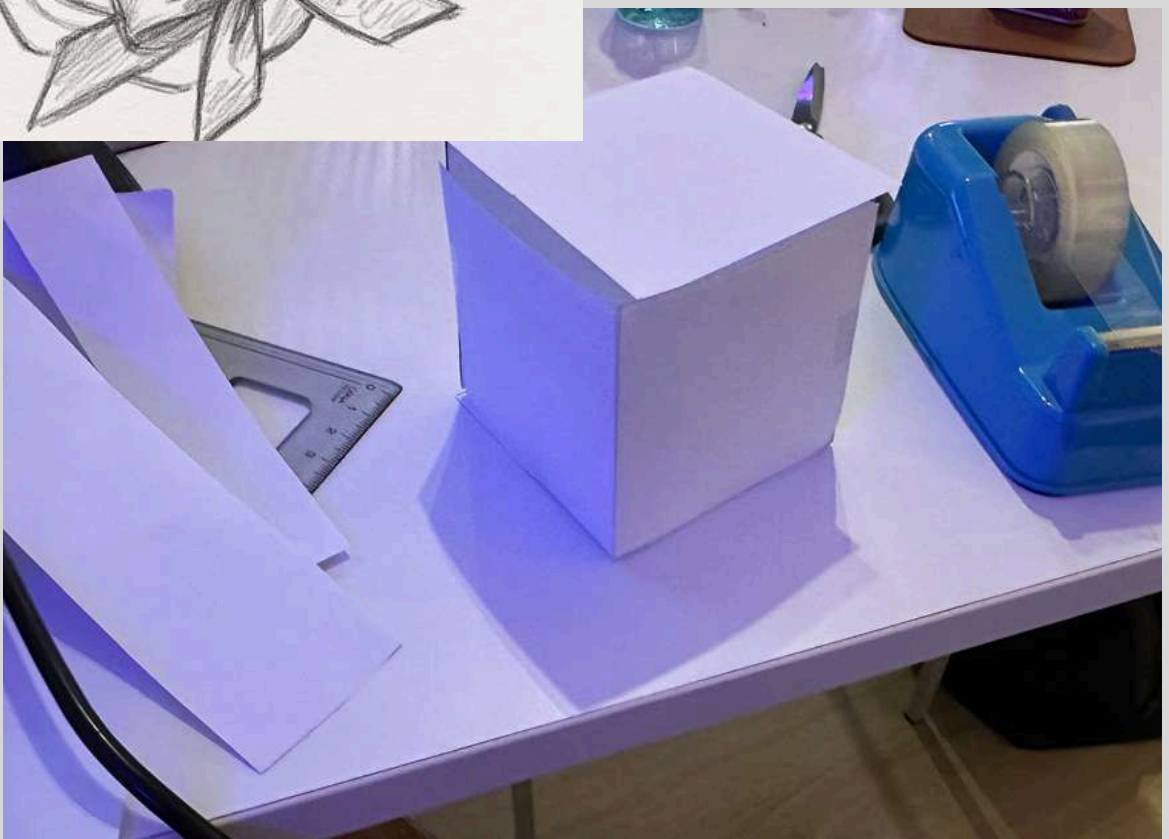


I: Low-Fi Prototypes

1. Pop-up Stand Concept
& Location Testing
Sketch & Mood Board



I: Low-Fi Prototypes



I: Low-Fi Prototypes



J: Project Timeline, deliverables, and budget



J: Project Timeline, deliverables, and budget

THE CONCEPT



As Moes Tuinen continues to expand, increasing brand awareness is crucial for attracting new customers and strengthening its presence in the local community. While current members appreciate the opportunity to rent land and cultivate their own vegetables, fruits, and flowers in a sustainable way, many potential customers—particularly expats and other residents—are still unaware of this unique offering. Enhancing Moes Tuinen's visibility through both in-person engagement and digital marketing will introduce more people to the benefits of community gardening, highlight its mission, and foster long-term customer relationships.

Summary

A **pop-up stand** activation at Amstelveen Stadshart* featuring the **giveaway** of 50-100 growing kits ('moestuintjes') to engage the community. Each kit will include a small **instruction guide** on how to grow the plants and a **QR code** linking to Moes Tuinen's website. Participants will be encouraged to document their growing journey on **social media** using a dedicated hashtag i.e. **#MoesTuinenAmstelveen**.

Additionally, **brochures** introducing Moes Tuinen's mission, vision, and services will be distributed to potential customers. To further boost engagement, social media content will be created, including:

- **Interviews** with current Moes Tuinen clients sharing their experiences.
- **Event coverage** showcasing public interactions at the pop-up stand.

This content can be shared on Moes Tuinen's social media platforms to expand reach and strengthen community connections.

*may be subject to change

J: Project Timeline, deliverables, and budget

DELIVERABLES

Survey (Google Forms) – A targeted questionnaire to gather insights from Moes Tuinen's customers and potential audience.

Interview Content – Video interviews featuring current Moes Tuinen customers sharing their gardening experiences.

Pop-up Stand Design – A visually appealing and branded stand concept, including layout, materials, and messaging.

Pop-up Stand Activation at Amstelveen Stadshart* – Execution of the event, including setting up the stand, interacting with visitors, and distributing materials.

Growing Kit Giveaways ('Moestuintjes') – Small gardening kits with QR codes linking to Moes Tuinen's website and social media.

Brochures & Flyers – Informational materials introducing Moes Tuinen's mission, services, and engagement opportunities.

Social Media Content –

1. Short-form videos from interviews.
2. Event footage from the pop-up stand.
3. User-generated content campaign (i.e. #MoesTuinenAmstelveen).

Targeted Social Media Strategy (part of the final report) – A structured plan for Moes Tuinen to enhance brand awareness and engagement online for future use.

Presentations – For internal use or stakeholder reporting, summarizing insights, progress, and recommendations.

10 Final Report – A detailed document covering research, execution, findings, and recommendations for Moes Tuinen's future marketing efforts.

J: Project Timeline, deliverables, and budget

PROJECT TIMELINE

Phase	Task	Date Range	Notes
Week 1	Finalize Project Plan & Budget	March 25 – March 29	Confirm details with Moes Tuinen
Week 2	Finalize & Distribute Survey	April 1 – April 5	Collect responses for insights
Week 3	Conduct Interviews with Moes Tuinen Customers	April 8 – April 12	Schedule and film content
Week 4	Analyze Survey & Interview Insights	April 15 – April 19	Identify key takeaways for strategy
Week 5	Design & Finalize Pop-up Stand Concept	April 22 – April 26	Create visuals, branding, and structure
Week 6	Order & Print Promotional Materials	April 29 – May 3	Brochures, banners, QR codes, growing kits
Week 7	Edit content from Interviews with Moes Tuinen Customers	May 6 – May 10	Content Editing
Week 8	Pop-up Stand Activation at Amstelveen Stadshart	May 13 – May 17	Execute event, engage with visitors
Week 9	Post-Event Social Media Content Editing	May 20 – May 24	Content Editing
Week 10	Evaluate Campaign Impact & Finalize Report	May 27 – May 31	Measure reach, feedback & next steps

* Presentation(s) TBD

J: Project Timeline, deliverables, and budget

*Prices include VAT

BUDGET

Promotional Stand			
	Cost (€)	Details	Source
Branded Stand	231,18€	(x1) Branded Stand – includes printing. The branding is not permanently applied (e.g., painted or fixed printing), allowing for future modifications.	Link
CapCut (1 month)	11.99€	Video Editing Software	Link
Moes Tuintjes Seed Growing Kit Giveaways			
	Cost (€)	Details	Source
Boxes	59,96 €	x4 = 200 boxes (white)	Link
Plant Growing Pots	31,8€	x2 = 200 biodegradable pieces	Link
Seeds	9,8€	x4 0.5g Cherry tomato seeds	Link
Soil tablets	21,96€	x2 = 200 coconut tablets for growing cuttings	Link
Printing			
	Cost (€)	Details	Source
10 pages 'MOES Tuinen' logos	22,14 €	A4 sticker paper	Link
17 pages 'cherry tomato grow kit'	30,76 €	A4 sticker paper	Link
100 instructions papers = 200 (split in 2)	22,64 €	A4 color paper	Link
200 flyers	34,40 €	A4 color paper	Link
Total	476,63 €		

J: Project Timeline, deliverables, and budget

* NOT FINAL DESIGN - JUST TO HELP ESTIMATE COST

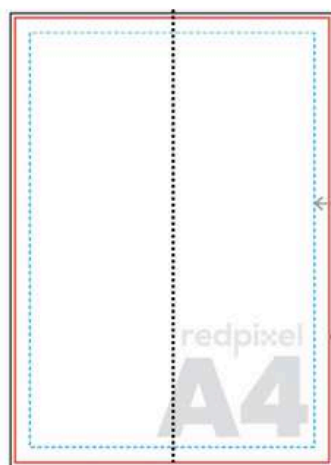
PRINTING EXAMPLES



17 PAGES 'CHERRY TOMATO GROW KIT'
A4 STICKER PAPER



10 PAGES 'MOES TUINEN' LOGOS
A4 STICKER PAPER



100 INSTRUCTIONS PAPERS = 200 (SPLIT IN 2)
A4 COLOR PAPER



200 FLYERS
A4 COLOR PAPER

K: Hi-Fi Prototypes - End product



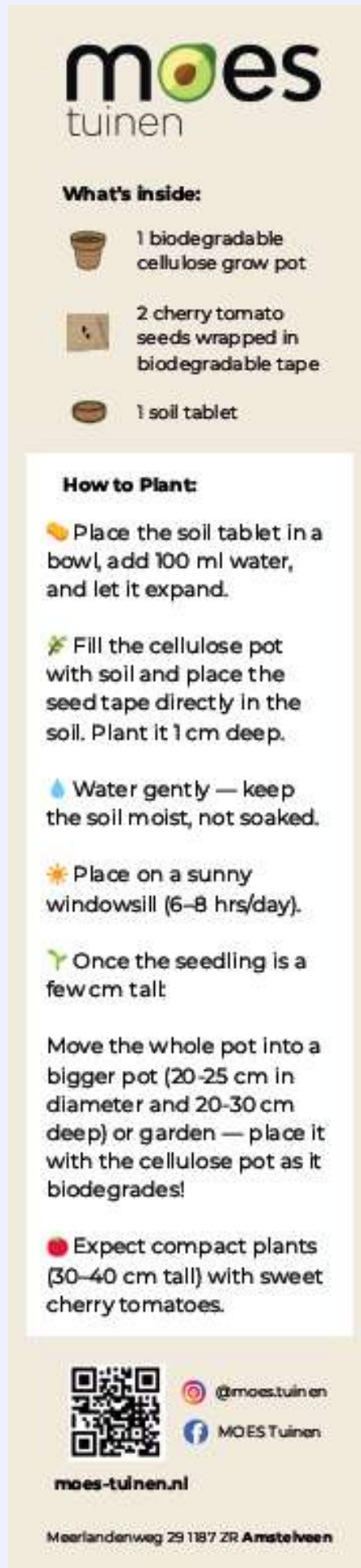
K: Hi-Fi Prototypes - End product



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K: Hi-Fi Prototypes - End product



Instruction leaflet
that came with
growkit giveaway

